

Today, a £50 transfer from Southall into a village in Punjab costs you about £8-10, if you want it on the same day. Through an SMS, you can do it for less than one penny. It is happening, we are just waiting for RBI approvals. Migrant labourers from Bihar send runners back home with envelopes. With one SMS at 60 paise you can transfer Rs 50, Rs 20, Rs 100 and instant access of cash on the other side.

I started a telecom company but I am certain it is not going to end up being a telecom company. We are no more telcos. We are actually becoming lifestyle providers. One telephone number or one telephone device is going to do everything for you. Today Google has developed tremendous capabilities on maps, many of you may have used Google Earth and Google Maps. In the near future, my phone will tell me all about my friends in a kilometre radius, more importantly guide me in buying a piece of textile or a pizza.

This is not going to stop. Business models will be different in tomorrow's world. You will cooperate and compete. World will truly become flat. It has taken us 70 years to come here. The telephone in 1876, the television in 1926, computers in late 1940s, all this is going to be crushed in the next 10 years into providing all of these through seamless single technology platforms. So, the customers can enjoy all the services at a click of a button. I believe we are living in times which are truly exciting.

HEMANT CHAWLA



"Connectivity will transform lives"

WIM ELFRINK

CHIEF GLOBALISATION OFFICER, CISCO

I represent a technology company and I want to start with a very humble type of remark that if we would have listened just to technology we wouldn't have been anywhere. We wouldn't have had the PC, we would have nuclear vacuum cleaners, as you can see, and copier machines wouldn't exist—so technology is just an enabler for great business leaders like we have here in the audience. And you should take this position that to get something out of technology and to dream about our vision that the network can change the way we work, play, live and learn has to be together based upon business vision.

We have never seen this in the history of mankind this enormous change of demographics by which Asia is going to reach five billion people. Europe is declining. China is already aging. The US is growing but at a completely different speed and South America is coming up. Africa is doubling. How are we going to make the average lives of citizens better? How can technology support it and enable prosperity for a bigger population of the world? My aim is to give you some transformational ideas of how you can even scale faster and globalise faster and use technology to benefit corporations and citizens to improve the quality of life.

We know 70 per cent of the world population today lives

